

Problem Statement

1. Business Context

The selected client is a small-scale laundry shop that has been operating for approximately three (3) years. The business is managed by one owner/manager and supported by two staff members who handle customer intake, laundry processing (washing, drying, folding, ironing), and customer assistance. The laundry shop offers regular services charged per kilo, as well as special services such as ironing, blankets, comforters, and rush orders with additional fees.

The business serves multiple customers daily, with higher workload during peak hours and rush orders. Due to the small team size, staff members often multitask, making efficient tracking and record management critical to daily operations.

2. Current System Description

Based on the conducted interview and on-site observation, the laundry shop currently relies on manual, paper-based processes to manage its operations. When a customer brings laundry, staff members manually weigh the items, discuss the service type, compute the price, and record all transaction details in a logbook. A handwritten claim stub containing the customer name, service type, weight, price, and expected pickup date is then issued to the customer.

Laundry order tracking is performed using physical tags, staff memory, and repeated logbook checks. Payment records are written separately in a daily notebook, with no computerized linkage between laundry orders and payment status. Staff members manually verify order readiness and payment completion before releasing laundry items to customers.

Records such as customer details, laundry orders, payments, and daily sales are kept on paper and typically retained for only three to six months, after which notebooks are stored or discarded due to space limitations.

3. Identified Problems

The reliance on manual processes has resulted in several operational problems:

a. Difficulty Tracking Laundry Status

Staff experience difficulty determining whether laundry orders are pending, processing, ready for pickup, or already released, especially during peak hours. This has led to confusion and occasional delays in service.

b. Risk of Mixed or Misidentified Orders

Due to the use of physical tags and manual memory-based tracking, there are instances where clothes from different customers are mixed, particularly when multiple rush orders are handled simultaneously.

c. Time-Consuming and Error-Prone Record Keeping

Manual recording of orders and payments is slow and prone to handwriting, computation, and omission errors, increasing staff workload and stress.

d. Unclear Payment Status

Because payment records are kept separately from order records, staff and the owner sometimes forget whether a laundry order has already been paid, increasing the risk of disputes and financial inaccuracies.

e. Limited Management Visibility

The owner has no quick way to view daily or monthly income, pending orders, or historical transactions. Generating such information requires manual review and computation from multiple notebooks.

4. Impact of the Problems

These problems negatively affect both operational efficiency and service reliability. Staff members experience increased stress and workload due to repeated checking of logbooks and manual verification steps. The owner faces difficulty monitoring business performance and ensuring accurate payment tracking.

Over time, these inefficiencies can lead to service delays, customer dissatisfaction, and potential financial loss. The lack of reliable records also limits the owner's ability to analyze business trends and make informed operational decisions.

5. Need for the Proposed System

The interview revealed a clear need for a simple, centralized, computer-based Laundry Shop Management System that can automate laundry order recording, status tracking, and payment management. The client explicitly identified automatic tracking of laundry status and payments as the most critical problem the system should solve.

Implementing a system-based solution will reduce manual workload, improve accuracy, provide real-time visibility of operations, and support better management decision-making while remaining appropriate for the scale and technical readiness of the business.

6. Problem Statement Summary

The laundry shop's current manual system is inefficient, error-prone, and insufficient for tracking laundry orders, payments, and business performance. Without an automated and centralized system, the business risks continued operational confusion, staff overload, and limited managerial control. A properly designed Laundry Shop Management System is therefore necessary to address these challenges and improve overall business operations.